

WHAT YOU RECEIVE

Budget & Scope Review

You bring the numbers — we pressure-test them. A licensed NC GC audits your existing budget and scope line by line against current market costs, finds the gaps, and hands back a number you can take to contractors and lenders.

PREPARED FOR

Sample Investor · budget audit · Charlotte NC
\$399 flat · 2 business days · NC GC License #107724

HOW TO READ THIS AUDIT

What we pressure-tested

You sent us a budget — a pro-forma, a spreadsheet, or a contractor bid. We audited every line against 2026 NC trade-network costs, checked the scope for missing items, and flagged the numbers that won't survive contractor pricing or lender review. This is the corrected, bid-grade version.

WHAT YOU SENT

1,420 sf cosmetic-plus rehab pro-forma · total budget submitted: **\$78,500** · 22 line items · prepared from a wholesaler's marketing sheet.

SAMPLE

THE VERDICT

Your budget vs. reality

UNDER BY ~\$24K

Submitted \$78,500 · realistic \$98,000–\$104,000. Three missing trades + four off-market lines.

THE HEADLINE

Your budget isn't wrong on the items it includes — it's wrong on the items it's missing. A rehab budget that pencils at \$78.5K here gets you to drywall and then stalls when the systems and contingency you didn't price show up.

SAMPLE

SCOPE GAP ANALYSIS

What your budget left out

MISSING ITEM	WHY IT'S REQUIRED	ADD
Panel replacement	Federal Pacific — uninsurable, will fail	\$2,800
Sewer lateral allowance	1956 clay line, unknown condition	\$4,500
Permit + inspection fees	Not a line in your sheet	\$1,400
Dumpster / disposal	Underpriced at \$400	\$2,200
Contingency (10%)	Zero contingency budgeted	\$9,000

THE BIG ONE

Zero contingency on a 1950s systems rehab is the single most expensive assumption in this budget. Behind-the-wall surprises aren't a maybe at this vintage — they're a when.

MARKET-RATE CORRECTIONS

Lines that are off-market

LINE ITEM	YOUR NUMBER	MARKET	DELTA
Kitchen (full reno)	\$12,000	\$18,200 – \$22,800	+\$8,200
HVAC replacement	\$6,500	\$8,800 – \$10,400	+\$3,000
Roof	\$6,000	\$8,600 – \$11,200	+\$3,200
Plumbing re-pipe	\$5,000	\$9,200 – \$12,400	+\$5,400

WHY THESE DRIFT

Marketing sheets carry last cycle's numbers. Kitchen and plumbing are where 2026 NC pricing has moved most — these two lines alone account for \$13.6K of the gap.

CONTINGENCY + RESERVES

What to hold back

RESERVE	RECOMMENDATION	BASIS
Construction contingency	10% of hard costs	1950s systems risk
Sewer scope reserve	\$250 (scope) + \$9K (if bad)	Unverified clay lateral
Holding-cost buffer	+2 weeks	Permit timeline variance

RULE OF THUMB

On pre-1970 NC rehabs we recommend a hard 10% contingency, not the 5% most spreadsheets carry. It's the difference between absorbing a surprise and re-trading the deal mid-build.

CORRECTED BID-GRADE BUDGET

The number you can actually use

CATEGORY	YOUR BUDGET	CORRECTED
Systems (HVAC/plumb/elec)	\$11,500	\$24,000
Kitchen / bath	\$16,000	\$28,000
Finishes	\$18,000	\$19,400
Envelope (roof/paint/ext)	\$14,000	\$17,200
Permits / disposal / misc	\$2,000	\$4,400
Contingency	\$0	\$9,000
TOTAL	\$78,500	\$102,000

NEXT STEP

Take a real number into the deal

WHAT THIS CHANGES

Re-run your deal math at \$102K, not \$78.5K. If it still pencils, you have a budget contractors will price against and lenders will fund. If it doesn't, you just avoided a deal that would have gone upside-down at drywall.

IF YOU NEED THE BUDGET BUILT, NOT AUDITED

This product audits a budget you have. If you're starting from scratch, the Contractor-Grade Budget builds one from full takeoffs.

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